Project Checkpoint Rubrics

Checkpoint 1: Design - 25 points

The repository should contain the three files specified below at a minimum. They are separate files as they will likely evolve somewhat during the project.

`README.md`

An overview of the project idea and a list of the members who joined the project.

- **Description:** description of the project's purpose and objectives
- **Motivation:** why will people want to use it? Who will it benefit (students, senior citizens, teachers, disabled, travelers, etc.)
- **Uniqueness:** what's different/unique about the project?
- **Who:** who is on the development team.

`DESIGN.md`

A high-level design document. It should include the following (at a minimum):

- **Tools:** tools and technologies you expect to use
- **Data/Services:** what data and services will the project require & how will you obtain them?
- **Architecture:** initial software architecture
- **Plan:** development plan

  The example plan provided in the `DESIGN.md` file in the starter repository is just an example, not a template.

  - *Lead:* who is the lead?
  - *Work:* who will do what?
  - **Milestones:** what are your milestones? How will you know if you're on schedule to finish by Dec 15th?

- *Order:* sequence of the work

`TESTING.md`

The draft testing plan - how will the team verify the various parts of the project are working properly.

The example provided in the `TESTING.md` file in the starter repository is just an example, not a template.

- **Test plan:** what is your test plan?

Checkpoint 2: Implementation - 25 points

Updated versions of the `README.md`, `DESIGN.md`, and `TESTING.md` files should account for any changes you made since the previous checkpoint.

> **Tip**
>
> It would be extremely unusual for there to be no changes to those original three documents.

Appropriate `.gitignore` and `LICENSE` files should be in the repository. Any `package.json` files should include the `author:`, `license:`, and `private:` fields with appropriate values.

> **Warning**
>
> Any submission repository that includes the `node_modules` directory will lose 5% of the possible score for that checkpoint.

In addition, a new file is added for Checkpoints 2 and 3: `IMPLEMENTATION.md`:

`IMPLEMENTATION.md`

- **Prerequisites:**
  List any prerequisite software and versions that your solution was built with in this section. I should be able to start in an empty directory, clone your repository and, after installing these prerequisites, be able to build and run your web app.
- **Building the app:**
  Explain exactly how to build your web app in this section.

  > **Important**

> If you do not provide complete instructions in the `README.md` file for me to build your submission, I will be unable to grade it. 😠

- **Running the app:**
  Explain exactly how to run your web app in this section. If you are providing the web app on `render.com` or some other site, be sure to include specific instructions on its use there.

Checkpoint 3: Delivery - 25 points

> **Important**
> I will be grading and producing final grades after the showcase. To give you time to incorporate any last minute changes, addition of feedback, etc., I will clone all project repositories at 22:00 (10 PM) EST on December 15, 2026. Late submissions will not be accepted.

Final versions of all documentation, source code, testing files/data/harnesses/etc. should be in the repository by the final deadline.

The `README.md` file must be extended to have a new section: **Future work**. That section should include:

- **Showcase feedback:**
  What did people think? What were their suggestions? If you showed your work to others, what did they say about it?
- **Project retrospective:**
  How did the project go? What was harder than you expected, what new stuff did you learn, etc.
- **What's next:**
  How should the work evolve from here? What new capabilities would you add if you had time and funding? What would make it even better?

Final submission checklist

- All the files required to build, test, and run your web app.
- The documentation files:
  - `README.md`
  - `DESIGN.md`
  - `TESTING.md`
  - `IMPLEMENTATION.md`
